Cornell University

ROPER CENTER

31098749
USVRS1992-STELEC-WA

Country: United States

Title: VRS 1992 Washington Election Day Exit Poll

Survey Organizations: Voter Research & Surveys

Sponsors: ABC News; CBS News; NBC News; CNN

Field Dates: November 3, 1992

Sample: Exiting Voters in Washington

Sample Size: 1549

Interview Modes: Mail questionnaire/Self-enumerated questionnaire

Weight Location: Columns 75-80 (xxx.xxx)

Usage Notes: Read all documentation before running data. A blank always represents an omit or non-response. Numerical values for the PRECINCT variable do not correspond with actual precinct numbers. Data labels for this variable have been removed to ensure respondent confidentiality.

Please note that data provided by the Roper Center for Public Opinion Research may not be re-disseminated without written permission. The results of any analyses conducted on the data may, however, be published with appropriate acknowledgments and source citation.

Voter Research & Surveys State Exit Poll Usage Notes:

Weights
Columns 75-80 contain respondent weights. These weights should be applied in all analyses. The weight has 3 implied decimal places, where '164222' in columns 75-80 means the respondent's weights=164.222

For additional information, see the Weighting section in the addendum on sampling procedures.

Backside Variable
When Column 66=1, there was at least one response on the backside of the questionnaire, which indicates that the questionnaire was turned over. This could allow the researcher to omit respondents when analyzing backside items

"Q" Vote
Original responses to Vote questions are in Columns 33, 34, 36, 37 with the descriptions QPresidential Vote, QSenate Vote, QGovernor Vote and QHouse Vote.

Columns 22, 23, 24, 25 with the descriptions Presidential, Senate, Governor and House Vote are responses to the same questions above, except that the "Other" and "Didn't vote" responses are recoded to "Blank". These columns were used for all broadcast and published analyses of VRS data.

Additional Items
Some items, not on the questionnaire, are added to the datasets. All surveys have the following add-ons:

Column Location	Description
65	State or National Questionnaire: 1=National 2=State
66	Completed Backside of Exit Poll (where appropriate): 1=Yes 2=No
68	Age (4 Categories): 1=18-29 2=30-44 3=45-59 4=60 and Over

69 Age (6 Categories)

1=18-24 2=25-29
3=30-34 4=40-49
5=50-59 6=60 and Over

71 Age 65 (6 Categories):

1=18-24 2=25-29
3=30-39 4=40-49
5=50-64 6=65 and Over

The various ages (Cols. 68, 69, 71) are regroupings of the original 8 category Age question in Column 19.

70 Party ID: (3 Categories)

1=Democrat
2=Republican
3=Independent/Else

Party ID is a regrouping of the 4 category Party ID in column 48.

*72 # of responses to the Issues question:
1, 2, or Blank

*Only in states with survey asking which issues mattered most

75-80 Weight (3 implied decimals)

17 Call Number 1- First Call
2- Second Call
3- Third Call

Interviewers called in results three times during election day. Call number indicates from which call a respondent came.

State Surveys

In each state a sample of exit poll precincts is drawn. Respondents in these precincts are given a "state" questionnaire. However, a subsample of these precincts is selected to be part of the VRS National sample, where respondents in these precincts are given a "national" questionnaire (instead of the "state" questionnaire). Since the national questionnaire has several items in common with the state questionnaire, a sample of national respondents is included in the state exit poll dataset. Column 65 indicates whether the respondent completed the state or national poll.

"State-Only" Questions

Items asked only on state questionnaires are marked with an asterisk (*) on the column location documentation. Select only respondents to the state poll, Column 65 = 2, when analyzing these "state-only" questions. National respondents will have a "blank" in those "state-only" columns since those items were not asked of them on the national questionnaire.

Blanks

A blank always represents an omit, or non-response to an item. However, there are two exceptions.

1) On checklist-type questions, such as "Do any of the following apply to you?" or "Were any of the items below very important in your presidential choice?", each of the listed items are coded '1' if they are checked and "blank" if not checked.

2) Responses to state-only questions on national questionnaires are left blank. As mentioned above, select only state questionnaires when analyzing state-only items in order to distinguish blanks that are true omits from inapplicable national questionnaires.

Add-on items

Column Location	Description
67	Geo Code (2 to 5 categories): VRS geographic region within a state (See column location documentation for codes)

Addendum

Sample Selection – The state samples were selected in two stages. First, a probability sample of voting precincts was selected that represented the different geographic areas across the state and the vote by party. Precincts were selected with a probability proportionate to the number of voters in each precinct. Each voter in the state has the same chance to have his or her precinct selected. There is one exception. In some states, precincts that have large minority populations have been sampled at a higher rate than other precincts. The sample weighting (described below) adjusts the representation of these precincts to their correct share of the total vote.

The national sample is a subsample of the state sample precincts. The probability of selecting these precincts is the same as if the sample had been selected at a uniform rate nationwide, and minority precincts had been selected again at a higher rate.

Within both state and national sample precincts voters were selected systematically throughout the voting day at a rate that gives all voters in a precinct the same chance of being interviewed.

Sampling Error – The error due to sampling depends on, among other things the number of respondents in each group. For example, if there are 1,500 respondents total in a sample, the sampling error on the percentage of men voting for a candidate depends on the number of men in the poll. In this example, if there are 750 men, the table below shows that the sampling error for 750 respondents to a typical question is 5.0%.

The sampling errors below are for most voter groups. There are 95 chances in 100 that a sample result is within this many percentage points of the result that would have been obtained by trying to interview every voter.

The sampling error also depends on how many precincts have voters with the characteristic of interest. For example, black or high income voters may be found clustered in only a few sample precincts. A characteristic that is clustered in a few precincts has a larger sampling error than characteristics that are not clustered such as age or sex. The sampling error may be up to 3 times larger for clustered characteristics.

Respondents in base of percentage	Error due to sampling
100	13.0%
250	8.0
500	6.0
750	5.0
1,000	4.0
1,500	3.5
2,000	3.0
2,500	2.5
5,000	2.0
7,500	1.5
10,000	1.3
12,500	1.1
15,000	1.1

Weighting – The tabulated results are weighted to reflect the different probabilities of selecting a precinct and of selecting a voter within each precinct. Minority precincts, that were selected at a higher rate, received a smaller weight than other precincts of the same size. For voters who are missed or refuse to be interviewed, there also is an adjustment which is based on their observed age, race and sex. Precincts in the national sample are weighted to regional totals during the day so that incomplete regional tallies can be combined in their correct proportions to form a national tally. Tabulations are meaningful only if they are weighted. Unweighted tabulations will make no sense.

Questionnaires – Respondents in national exit poll precincts will be given one of the four versions of the national questionnaire. Two versions have the identical questions: however, the response categories for the "important issues" and "candidate qualities" questions are in reverse order on the two versions of those questionnaires. (The state polls ask these questions in fixed order only.) The questions on these two national versions combined will be answered by about 7,000 voters. Each of the other two versions will have different questions. Those versions will have 3,500 respondents each.

All national poll questionnaires will ask the presidential vote, the vote for House and some common demographics. House of Representatives candidates are identified by party only on the questionnaires. Each interviewer has a list of the House candidates on the ballot at their precinct. In Congressional districts with uncontested races the sole candidate is automatically checked as the winner.

The questionnaires in each state differ somewhat. There is only one state questionnaire in each state except California; it has two questionnaires, with mostly different questions on each. There are eight questions common to all states: age, sex, race, income, vote for President in 1988, party identification, condition of the national economy, and personal financial situation. There are additional questions in each state.

State tabulations can have questions based on different sample sizes. If a question appears only on a state exit poll questionnaire, it will have a smaller sample size than will questions that are on both the state and the national questionnaire used in that state. The sample sizes on the top of the state exit poll documentation are the total sample sizes for the state and national questionnaires combined.

VOTER RESEARCH & SURVEYS

WASHINGTON
GENERAL ELECTION 1992

Your answers are confidential
Please do not sign your name

A **Are You:**

1 ☐ Male 2 ☐ Female

B **Are You:**

1 ☐ White
2 ☐ Black
3 ☐ Hispanic/Latino
4 ☐ Asian
5 ☐ Other

C **In Today's Election For President, Did You Just Vote For:**

1 ☐ Bill Clinton (Dem)
2 ☐ George Bush (Rep)
3 ☐ Ross Perot (Ind)
4 ☐ Other: Who?_____
5 ☐ Didn't vote for President

D **Do You Think That The Condition Of The Nation's Economy Is:**

1 ☐ Excellent
2 ☐ Good
3 ☐ Not so good
4 ☐ Poor

E **Should The Senate Have Confirmed Clarence Thomas To The Supreme Court After Anita Hill's Accusation?**

1 ☐ Yes
2 ☐ No
3 ☐ Not sure

F **How Did You Vote On Initiative 573: To Deny Candidates Ballot Access Who Have Already Served For Specific Time Periods?**

1 ☐ Yes
2 ☐ No
3 ☐ Did not vote on Initiative 573

G **To Which Age Group Do You Belong?**

1 ☐ 18-24 5 ☐ 45-49
2 ☐ 25-29 6 ☐ 50-59
3 ☐ 30-39 7 ☐ 60-64
4 ☐ 40-44 8 ☐ 65 or over

H **In Today's Election For U.S. Senator, Did You Just Vote For:**

1 ☐ Patty Murray (Dem)
2 ☐ Rod Chandler (Rep)
4 ☐ Other: Who?_____
5 ☐ Didn't vote for Senator

I **In Today's Election For Governor, Did You Just Vote For:**

1 ☐ Mike Lowry (Dem)
2 ☐ Ken Eikenberry (Rep)
4 ☐ Other: Who?_____
5 ☐ Didn't vote for Governor

J **Which Comes Closest To Your Position? Abortion Should Be:**

1 ☐ Legal in all cases
2 ☐ Legal in most cases
3 ☐ Illegal in most cases
4 ☐ Illegal in all cases

K **Who Did You Vote For In The 1988 Presidential Election?**

1 ☐ George Bush (Rep)
2 ☐ Michael Dukakis (Dem)
3 ☐ Someone else
4 ☐ Did not vote in 1988

PLEASE TURN QUESTIONNAIRE OVER

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L **If Ross Perot Had Not Been On The Ballot Today, Who Would You Have Voted For?**

1 ☐ Bill Clinton
2 ☐ George Bush
3 ☐ Other: Who?_____
4 ☐ Would not have voted for President

M **How Important Is It That More Women Be Elected To The U.S. Senate?**

1 ☐ Very important
2 ☐ Somewhat important
3 ☐ Not important

N **Are You:**

1 ☐ Out of work and looking for work
2 ☐ Employed full-time
3 ☐ Employed part-time
4 ☐ Full-time student
5 ☐ Homemaker
6 ☐ Retired

O **Are You:**

1 ☐ Protestant
2 ☐ Catholic
3 ☐ Other Christian
4 ☐ Jewish
5 ☐ Something else
6 ☐ None

P **Compared To Four Years Ago, Is Your Family's Financial Situation:**

1 ☐ Better today
2 ☐ Worse today
3 ☐ About the same

Q **No Matter How You Voted Today, Do You Usually Think Of Yourself As A:**

1 ☐ Democrat
2 ☐ Republican
3 ☐ Independent
4 ☐ Something else

R **1991 Total Family Income:**

1 ☐ Under $15,000
2 ☐ $15,000-$29,999
3 ☐ $30,000-$49,999
4 ☐ $50,000-$74,999
5 ☐ $75,000 or over

S **Do Any Of The Following Apply To You:** (Please Answer All Questions)

		YES	NO
Strong environmentalist	1	☐	☐
Born-again Christian/Fundamentalist	2	☐	☐
Military veteran	3	☐	☐
Someone in household belongs to a labor union	4	☐	☐
Someone in household works in the timber industry	5	☐	☐
Have a child under 18 living at home	6	☐	☐
Attend religious services at least once a week	7	☐	☐
Currently married	8	☐	☐
Once thought that I would vote for Ross Perot	9	☐	☐

Please fold the questionnaire and put it in the box. Thank you.

WA

Voter Research and Survey Exit Poll

Washington General Election Exit Poll
November 3, 1992

Total number of respondents : 1549

COLUMN LOCATIONS	DESCRIPTIONS [Question ID]
1	'1'
2 - 6	Sequence Number (00001 - XXXXX)
7	'G'
8	'0'
9 - 10	State Number WASHINGTON = '48'
11 - 13	Precinct Number
14 - 16	Sequence Number Within Precinct
17	Call Number: 1=First Call 2=Second Call 3=Third Call
18	'1'
19	Age(8 categories): 1=18-24 2=25-29 3=30-39 4=40-44 5=45-49 6=50-59 7=60-64 8=65 or over
20	Race [B]: 1=White 2=Black 3=Hispanic/Latino 4=Asian 5=Other
21	Sex [A]
22	Presidential Vote [C]
23	Senate Vote [H]
24	Governor Vote [I]

COLUMN LOCATIONS		DESCRIPTIONS [Question ID]	(WA)
31	*	Should Senate Have Confirmed Thomas [E]	
33		QPresidential Vote	(VRS)
34		QSenate Vote	(VRS)
35	*	I 573: Term Limits [F]	
36		QGovernor Vote	(VRS)
38	*	Importance Of More Women Senators [M]	
45		88 Presidential Vote [K]	
46		Abortion Positon [J]	
47		Second Choice After Perot [L]	
48		Party ID [Q]: (4 Categories) 1=Democrat 2=Republican 3=Independent 4=Else	
50		Nation's Economy [D]	
53		Financial Situation [P]	
54		Family Income [R] 1=Under 15K 2=15-30K 3=30-50K 4=50-75K 5=Over 75K	
55	*	Strong Environmentalist [S]	
56		Born-Again Christian [S]	
57		Military Veteran [S]	
58		Union Member in HH [S]	
59	*	Timber Employee In HH [S]	
60		Child Under 18 In HH [S]	
61		Attend Weekly Religious Services [S]	
62	*	Currently Married [S]	

COLUMN LOCATIONS		DESCRIPTIONS [Question ID] (WA)
63	*	Once Would Voted For Perot [S]
64		Employment [N] 1=Out Of Work, Looking 2=Employed Full Time 3=Employed Part Time 4=Full Time Student 5=Homemaker 6=Retired
65		State or National Poll 1=National 2=State
66		Completed Backside of Exit Poll: 1=Yes 2=No
67		Geo Code: 1=King County (VRS) 2=Puget Sound/East Shore 3=Olympic Mountain 4=East
68		Age (4 Categories): 1=18 - 29 (VRS) 2=30 - 44 3=45 - 59 4=60 and Over
69		Age (6 Categories): 1=18 - 24 (VRS) 2=25 - 29 3=30 - 39 4=40 - 49 5=50 - 59 6=60 and Over
70		Party ID: (3 Categories) (VRS) 1=Democrat 2=Republican 3=Independent/Other
75-80		WEIGHT (3 implied decimal places)

SINGLE COL FREQUENCIES FOR USVRS1992-STELEC-WA (COLS. 1-80) / NCARDS 1549

COL	&	-	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	BLANK	OTHER	NONBLNK	COL
1	0	0	0	1549	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1549	1
2	0	0	1549	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1549	2
3	0	0	999	550	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1549	3
4	0	0	199	200	200	200	200	150	100	100	100	100	0	0	1549	4
5	0	0	159	160	160	160	160	150	150	150	150	150	0	0	1549	5
6	0	0	154	155	155	155	155	155	155	155	155	155	0	0	1549	6
7	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1549	1549	7
8	0	0	1549	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1549	8
9	0	0	0	0	0	0	1549	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1549	9
10	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1549	0	0	0	1549	10
11	0	0	1549	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1549	11
12	0	0	142	255	118	122	208	146	54	220	165	119	0	0	1549	12
13	0	0	136	73	120	89	206	220	102	119	244	240	0	0	1549	13
14	0	0	1549	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1549	14
15	0	0	286	299	307	288	240	83	33	10	3	0	0	0	1549	15
16	0	0	143	173	168	164	156	149	145	148	151	152	0	0	1549	16
17	0	0	0	361	421	767	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1549	17
18	0	0	0	1549	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1549	18
19	0	0	0	198	154	419	205	170	185	74	140	0	4	0	1545	19
20	0	0	0	1407	42	22	34	31	0	0	0	0	13	0	1536	20
21	0	0	0	718	754	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	77	0	1472	21
22	0	0	0	717	430	369	0	0	0	0	0	0	33	0	1516	22
23	0	0	0	847	648	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	54	0	1495	23
24	0	0	0	829	677	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	43	0	1506	24
25	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1549	0	0	25
26	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1549	0	0	26
27	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1549	0	0	27
28	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1549	0	0	28
29	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1549	0	0	29
30	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1549	0	0	30
31	0	0	0	419	614	258	0	0	0	0	0	0	258	0	1291	31
32	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1549	0	0	32
33	0	0	0	717	430	369	14	5	0	0	0	0	14	0	1535	33
34	0	0	0	847	648	0	5	37	0	0	0	0	12	0	1537	34
35	0	0	0	644	555	82	0	0	0	0	0	0	268	0	1281	35
36	0	0	0	829	677	0	3	27	0	0	0	0	13	0	1536	36
37	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1549	0	0	37
38	0	0	0	550	465	256	0	0	0	0	0	0	278	0	1271	38
39	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1549	0	0	39
40	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1549	0	0	40
41	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1549	0	0	41
42	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1549	0	0	42
43	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1549	0	0	43
44	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1549	0	0	44
45	0	0	0	726	508	54	238	0	0	0	0	0	23	0	1526	45
46	0	0	0	614	485	302	100	0	0	0	0	0	48	0	1501	46
47	0	0	0	816	539	31	53	0	0	0	0	0	110	0	1439	47
48	0	0	0	534	468	432	62	0	0	0	0	0	53	0	1496	48
49	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1549	0	0	49
50	0	0	0	22	270	774	477	0	0	0	0	0	6	0	1543	50
51	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1549	0	0	51
52	0	0	0	621	248	275	15	100	232	0	0	0	58	0	1491	52
53	0	0	0	428	496	586	0	0	0	0	0	0	39	0	1510	53
54	0	0	0	195	381	450	306	127	0	0	0	0	90	0	1459	54
55	0	0	0	650	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	899	0	650	55
56	0	0	0	286	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1263	0	286	56
57	0	0	0	301	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1248	0	301	57
58	0	0	0	417	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1132	0	417	58
59	0	0	0	136	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1413	0	136	59
60	0	0	0	614	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	935	0	614	60
61	0	0	0	497	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1052	0	497	61
62	0	0	0	846	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	703	0	846	62
63	0	0	0	597	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	952	0	597	63
64	0	0	0	85	841	167	76	120	173	0	0	0	87	0	1462	64
65	0	0	0	241	1308	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1549	65
66	0	0	0	1520	29	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1549	66
67	0	0	0	496	305	416	332	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1549	67
68	0	0	0	352	624	355	214	0	0	0	0	0	4	0	1545	68
69	0	0	0	198	154	419	375	185	214	0	0	0	4	0	1545	69
70	0	0	0	534	468	494	0	0	0	0	0	0	53	0	1496	70
71	0	0	0	198	154	419	375	259	140	0	0	0	4	0	1545	71
72	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1549	0	0	72
73	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1549	0	0	73
74	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1549	0	0	74
75	0	0	1549	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1549	75
76	0	0	1549	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1549	76
77	0	0	934	535	61	8	7	4	0	0	0	0	0	0	1549	77
78	0	0	120	90	139	163	139	260	169	168	158	143	0	0	1549	78
79	0	0	144	153	211	148	152	183	130	148	143	137	0	0	1549	79
80	0	0	126	149	157	111	191	173	158	143	182	159	0	0	1549	80